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Precarious ceasefire facing stress tests

Iran closes Hormuz as Israel intensifies attacks in Lebanon

By Bassem Mroue, Jon Gambrell, Samy Magdy and Sam Metz
ASSOCIATED PRESS

TEHRAN, Iran — The U.S. demanded Wednesday that Iran reopen the Strait of Hormuz after the Islamic Republic closed the waterway in response to Israeli attacks against the Hezbollah militant group in Lebanon. Iran's move cast doubt over whether an already precarious ceasefire to end more than a month of war would hold.

The U.S. and Iran both claimed victory after reaching the agreement, and world leaders expressed relief, even as more drones and missiles hit Iran and Gulf Arab countries. Israel intensified its attacks in Lebanon, hitting several commercial and residential areas in Beirut without warning. At least 182 people were killed and hundreds were wounded in one of the deadliest days in the latest Israel-Hezbollah war.

The fresh violence threatened to scuttle what Vice President JD Vance called a “fragile” deal.

Iranian Parliament Speaker Mohammad Bagher Ghalibaf said planned talks with the U.S. to seek a permanent halt to hostilities were “unreasonable” because Washington broke three of Tehran's 10 conditions for an end to the fighting. In a social media post, Ghalibaf objected to Israeli attacks on Hezbollah, an alleged drone incursion into Iranian airspace after the ceasefire went into effect and the U.S. assertion that it will not accept any Iranian enrichment capabilities in a final agreement.

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MORE COVERAGE: Gulf nations enter a troubling new reality as the U.S.-Israeli war with Iran has destroyed any sense of safety. **Nation & World, Page B4**



Dental assistant Cerrita Mills checks a preschooler's teeth while paraprofessional educator Rosie Sierra holds the child's hand at Kimberly Heights School on April 1 in Tinley Park. The dental clinic was run by Universal Dental Clinics. They expected to see over 100 preschoolers and kindergarteners during the session. **STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Participation in school dental program decays

Dentists pushing to hand the state oversight of arrangement that helps CPS children

By Jack O'Connor
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

SPRINGFIELD — For decades, dentists across Illinois have taken time out of their daily schedules to swap sterile offices for public schools, providing checkups, fluoride treatments and cleanings to children who might otherwise go without dental care.

In Chicago Public Schools alone, city officials say the program has reached more than 1.3 million students, serving children in some of the city's most underserved neighborhoods at

no cost to families.

But in recent years, frustration with the Chicago Department of Public Health, which oversees dental providers in CPS schools, has begun to erode the program, with the number of participating dental groups and the share of CPS students being cut nearly in half. And some providers now are saying they are on the verge of walking away entirely.

Amid the decline, a bill is advancing in the Illinois General Assembly that would strip the city of its oversight role and hand it to the state.

While city health officials warn such a switch would remove critical safeguards and undermine a partnership they say has long served students well, some dental providers say it is needed to fix a city bureaucratic breakdown that has grown increasingly difficult to navigate under new CDPH leadership. It's been marked by what those providers describe as hostile inspections, interference with clinical decisions and billing rules that can force them to absorb the cost of treating uninsured students with no reimbursement.

“Dental teams started receiving

unusually harsh reviews. Clinical treatment decisions were questioned or even dictated. Some teams were sanctioned and even threatened with closure,” Dr. Luciana Sweis, whose Dental Caravan had provided dental services to CPS schools for two decades, told the Illinois Senate Health and Human Services Committee in February. “Over time, qualified employees chose to leave rather than work under those conditions.”

Unlike the rest of Illinois, where

See **DENTAL** on Page A4



Trent Hinkle, a farmhand who cares for the horses, brings Troy, center, home to see his barn mate Lilly on Wednesday after Troy was rescued Saturday from a flooded creek in Marengo. **BRIAN CASSELLA/TRIBUNE**

Horse welcomed home after rescue

Marengo animal was stranded in creek, is back from hospital

By Madeline King
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

A Marengo horse received a warm homecoming Wednesday afternoon from his stay in an equine hospital after he was stranded in a creek, rescuing in a daylong, 45-person rescue mission.

Troy — who is a Pony of the

Americas, according to his owners, the Beaulieu family — pranced around his yard upon exiting the hospital trailer, receiving pets and apples. Inside the stables, the family's other two horses greeted Troy with affectionate sniffs, snuggles and neighs.

They hadn't seen Troy since he went missing sometime on Friday, according to Trent Hinkle, who has looked after the horses as the barnhand for five years. Hinkle said he realized Troy was gone at about 7 p.m. Friday night but couldn't find him in the dark. The

horses often graze and roam the tens of acres of land the Beaulieus own, but usually, they come back to the stables, Hinkle explained.

Hinkle said he found Troy around 7 a.m. Saturday stranded in a creek. He believes Troy got swept about a half mile from the family's house on Anthony Road by the fast current and rising water levels from the rains.

“He is definitely a survivor,” Hinkle said.

Shortly after finding Troy,

See **HORSE** on Page A5

City's zoning committee to skip another month

Developments in limbo, but alderman has plan for a deal

By Jake Sheridan
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Chicago developers and property owners — from major construction firms to homeowners seeking routine zoning changes — will again face delays as a monthslong City Council feud over who should lead the influential Zoning Committee drags into spring.

But the alderman who has tentatively led the committee says he's got a political maneuver of his own that could end the political impasse.

Interim Chair Ald. Bennett Lawson, 44th, told the Tribune

on Wednesday he will not hold a Zoning Committee meeting in April, the third month this year without one. He said he will continue to refuse to convene the committee until aldermen select a permanent chair.

The standoff has paralyzed one of the council's most consequential bodies and left a growing backlog of zoning proposals in limbo as the committee reviews zoning changes required to begin construction projects of all kinds across the city. Without its approval, projects cannot move forward. A backlog grew when Lawson skipped January's meeting, grew further when he skipped March's, and will grow again next month.

But the increasingly impactful holdup could end soon, as Lawson

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INSIDE

Bulls committed to Donovan

The respect between Bulls ownership and head coach Billy Donovan has been a rare throughline for the last six years. Despite a losing record, Donovan has inspired loyalty at all levels for his work ethic, attention to detail and player-first mentality. The Bulls are committed to Donovan. Now it's time to test whether Donovan is ready to recommit to the Bulls. **Sports**



CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

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